Governors' Payment of Expenses Policy

This policy statement has been developed in accordance with the Education (Governors' Allowances) Regulations 2003 (see Appendix) which give Governing Bodies the discretion to pay expenses from the school's annual budget allocation to members of Governing Bodies for certain expenses which they incur in carrying out their duties. Howbridge Infant School Governing Body believes that meeting the expenses of members of the Governing Body in specific categories as set out below, is important in ensuring equality of opportunity to serve as members of the Governing Body for all members of the community and so is an appropriate use of school funds. The specific items allowable reflect this objective.

Members of the Governing Body include all categories of Governors and Associate Members. At the discretion of the Resources Committee, payment of expenses incurred may be approved on behalf of anyone who is invited to attend a meeting of the Governing Body for a specific item of business.

From 15 September 2010, all members of the Governing Body of Howbridge Infant School will be entitled to claim the actual costs which they incur as follows:

1 Members of the Governing Body will be able to claim expenses providing the expenses are incurred in carrying out their duties, as a Governor or Governing Body representative of the Howbridge Infant School.

2 Members of the Governing Body will be able to claim for the following, on a case-by-case basis:

- Childcare or baby sitting expenses (excluding payments to a current/former spouse or partner) up to £6 per hour.
- Cost of care arrangements for an elderly or dependent relative (excluding payments to a current/former spouse or partner);
- The extra costs they incur in performing their duties either because they have special needs or because English is not their first language;
- The cost of travel relating only to travel to meetings/training courses at a rate of 45 pence per mile;
- Travel and subsistence costs, payable at the current local government agreed rates associated with attending national meetings or training events, unless these costs can be claimed from any other source;
- Telephone charges, photocopying, stationery, postage or any other justifiable and reasonable expense.
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The Governing Body at Howbridge Infant School acknowledges that:

- Members of the Governing Body may not be paid attendance allowance;
- Members of the Governing Body may not be reimbursed for loss of earnings.
- Members of the Governing Body have agreed only to claim expenses under extraordinary circumstances, for example if financial constraints mean a journey or attendance would not be possible without reimbursement of expenses.

Members of the Governing Body wishing to make claims under these arrangements, should complete a claim form (obtainable from the School Office), attaching receipts (VAT receipts if applicable) to all claims, and return it to the School Business Manager (via the Chair of the Resources Committee for authorisation) as soon as practically possible after the expenses were incurred.

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Claims may be subject to independent audit and may be investigated by the Chair of Governors (or Chair of Resources Committee) if they appear excessive or inconsistent.

This policy and the allowable rates stipulated, will be reviewed annually by the Resources Committee of the Governing Body. A report of all Governing Body expenses claimed will be reported to the Resources Committee on a regular basis.

Appendix

DfE Regulations: (School Governance (Roles, Procedures and Allowances) (England) Regulations 2013)

Key Messages

- Governing bodies can continue to choose whether or not to pay allowances to Governors. The Department thinks that it is good practice to pay such allowances as Governors should not be out of pocket for the valuable work they do. Governors should be able to claim legitimate allowances where governing bodies have set up schemes to make such payments.

- Payments can be made for any expenditure necessarily incurred by individual Governors to enable them to carry out governor duties.

- Allowances for travel cannot exceed the Inland Revenue Authorised Mileage Rates. Payments of other allowances must only be made on provision of a receipt. The amount to be paid should be determined by the governing body and be limited to the amount shown on the receipt.

- Governors cannot claim attendance allowances i.e. payment for attending meetings themselves, or for loss of earnings.

- Allowances can be paid to Governors serving on temporary governing bodies, and to associate members.

- Governor allowances will continue to be paid from the school's delegated budget.

Howbridge Infant School

Governing Body Expenses Claims Form

Name:	**Howbridge Infant School**
Address: **Post Code**	**Date:**

I claim the total sum of £…… for Governing Body expenses as detailed below. I have attached relevant VAT receipts to support my claim.

Signed……..……

	Date incurred	**Amount**
Child care/babysitting expenses		
Care arrangements for an elderly or dependent relative		
Support for Members with special requirements		
Travel/subsistence (details to be provided)		
Other Expenses (details to be provided)		
TOTAL EXPENSES CLAIMED		

This form should be submitted to the Office Manager via the Chair of Resources Committee (or Chair of Governors if the claim made by Chair of Resources)

Authorised by Chair of Resources Committee Signature ……

Date ……..

Approved by Office Manager Signature ……...

Date ……